

CDRECORD

Most Linux distributions have command line utility to burn CDs and DVDs. This command along with mkisofs completes the package of disc media writing. The newer Linux distributions supports DVD writing the eariler one dont. For more on how to use this utility refer Digit February 2006 Tips and Tricks.

Lets say, you want to mount your Windows partition at the startup. Windows partitions are located under */dev/hdb1*, */dev/hdb5*, */dev/hdb6*. Create a folder called '*win*' under say */root* or */mnt* and then create folder under win for each of the three partitions. We used the drive letter as file names for the mount points. Therefore, when mounted, the Windows partition would appear under */mnt/win/C*, */mnt/win/D* and */mnt/win/E*. To automate the mounting of these partitions, just open a '*fstab*' in a text editor and make the following entries:

<i>/dev/hdb1</i>	<i>/mnt/win/C</i>	<i>vfat</i>	<i>defaults 0 0</i>
<i>/dev/hdb5</i>	<i>/mnt/win/D</i>	<i>vfat</i>	<i>defaults 0 0</i>
<i>/dev/hdb6</i>	<i>/mnt/win/E</i>	<i>vfat</i>	<i>defaults 0 0</i>

Use ntfs instead of vfat if the partition is of that file system. Linux will warn you about mounting NTFS partitions—it mounts NTFS as read only. Having said that, there is absolutely no problem in mounting FAT32 partitions. Save the file and exit the editor. No need to restart the machine to check if it works. Use the '*mount -a*' command to test if the changes worked. If so, it will work at every start up. A little detail about the columns of '*fstab*' are provided in the table on the next page.

Using Shell Scripts

Any novice can use shell scripting effectively, provided he/she has good idea of shell commands. Taking the above mount process as an example, lets create a shell script to mount the Windows partitions only when required. All we have to do is to list the mount command with the mount device and mount point (both should be valid) in a text file using some editor (don't add extesion such as